

上智大学 英語 過去問風演習

長文読解 一本番想定 (大問 1 題・30 分)

2026年5月26日

高校3年～既卒 (上智大学 文系志望)

英語 (長文読解・上智本番レベル)

Trillion 塾

Reading Comprehension (30 min, 35 pts) [配点 35 点]

Read the following passage and answer the questions below.

For decades, urban planners assumed that cars would dominate the future of transportation. Highways were widened, parking lots multiplied, and entire neighborhoods were demolished to make way for automobiles. (A) But by the early twenty-first century, the limitations of car-centric design had become painfully evident. Traffic congestion, air pollution, and the social isolation produced by sprawling suburbs forced a rethinking of what makes a city livable.

The Dutch city of Utrecht offers an instructive case study. Once a traditional car-friendly European city, Utrecht began in the 1990s to systematically reduce car traffic in its center. Streets were converted to bicycle paths, parking lots became parks, and public squares were reclaimed for pedestrians. (B) What was once a noisy, congested downtown was transformed into one of the most pleasant urban environments in Europe.

Crucially, this transformation was not the result of a sudden ban on cars. Instead, it proceeded through dozens of small, incremental changes over thirty years. Each individual modification was modest, but the cumulative effect was a fundamental reimagining of urban life. Cyclists now outnumber drivers in Utrecht's center by a ratio of three to one, and air quality has improved substantially.

(C) Critics often dismiss such European examples as inapplicable to North American cities, where distances are greater and car culture is more entrenched. Yet several American cities — Minneapolis, Portland, and Cambridge, among others — have begun similar experiments, demonstrating that the principles can be adapted across cultural contexts. The key insight is that cities are not fixed objects; they are continuously shaped by the choices we make about how we want to live.

(Original passage for Trillion 塾)

Notes:

car-centric — 自動車中心の

sprawling suburbs — 無秩序に広がる郊外

incremental — 段階的な

entrenched — 深く根付いた

Reading Comprehension (30 min, 35 pts) — Questions

Q1 1

What does the underlined sentence (A) suggest about car-centric urban design?

- ① It was the only viable approach for modern cities.
- ② Its drawbacks became clearly visible by the early 21st century.
- ③ It successfully solved all urban transportation problems.
- ④ It is a uniquely European phenomenon.

Q2 2

What is the main point of underlined sentence (B)?

- ① Downtown areas should always remain busy and loud.
- ② Utrecht's downtown changed from a traffic-heavy area into one of Europe's most pleasant urban environments.
- ③ Utrecht's transformation failed to produce visible results.
- ④ Pedestrians prefer congested downtowns.

Q3 3

According to the passage, what is the ratio of cyclists to drivers in central Utrecht?

- ① one to three
- ② three to one
- ③ ten to one
- ④ equal numbers

Q4 4

What argument is described in underlined sentence (C)?

- ① European examples are universally applicable everywhere.
- ② Critics argue that European urban transformations may not apply to North American cities due to differences in distance and car culture.
- ③ All American cities have rejected car-centric design.
- ④ European cities have abandoned bicycle infrastructure.

Q5 5

Which best summarizes the author's main conclusion?

- ① American cities are fundamentally different from European cities and cannot change.
- ② Cities are shaped by our choices and can evolve through incremental changes.
- ③ Cars will always dominate transportation.
- ④ Urban planners should stop experimenting with new designs.

Q6 6

The word 'cumulative' in paragraph 3 most nearly means:

- ① expensive
- ② accumulating over time
- ③ rapid and sudden
- ④ irreversible

Q7 7

Why does the author cite Minneapolis, Portland, and Cambridge?

- ① To prove that all cities have similar climates.
- ② To demonstrate that the principles of Utrecht's transformation can be adapted to North American contexts.
- ③ To criticize American transportation policy.
- ④ To explain Europe's economic decline.

解答・解説

問	解答	解説
1	②	【正解】② 下線部 (A) は「By the early twenty-first century, the limitations ... had become painfully evident」と21世紀初頭までに限界が明確になったと述べる。
2	②	【正解】② 下線部 (B) は「once a noisy, congested downtown was transformed into one of the most pleasant urban environments in Europe」とUtrechtの劇的変化を要約。
3	②	【正解】② 第3段落「Cyclists now outnumber drivers ... by a ratio of three to one」と明記。
4	②	【正解】② 下線部 (C) は批判の引用: 「Critics often dismiss such European examples as inapplicable to North American cities, where distances are greater and car culture is more entrenched」と一致。
5	②	【正解】② 最終文「cities are not fixed objects; they are continuously shaped by the choices we make」と一致。
6	②	【正解】② cumulative = 累積する。「Each individual modification was modest, but the cumulative effect was a fundamental reimagining」= 「個々の変更は控えめだが累積効果は根本的な再構想」。

問	解答	解説
7	②	【正解】 ② 第 4 段落「several American cities ... have begun similar experiments, demonstrating that the principles can be adapted across cultural contexts」と一致。